PPP-P-225C
December 18, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. PPP-P-00225B(GSA-FSS)
March 25, 1970

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY REQUIREMENTS FOR DESKS, GENERAL OFFICE, STEEL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the packaging, packing, and marking requirements (see 6.1) for general office steel desks covered by AA-D-00191.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378 - Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
AA-D-00191 - Desks, Steel, General Office.
FF-N-105 - Nails, Brads, Staples and Spikes: Wire, Cut and Wrought.
QQ-S-781 - Strapping, Steel, Flat and Seals.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-C-843 - Cushioning Material, Cellulosic.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.
PPP-S-760 - Strapping, Nonmetallic (And Connectors).
PPP-T-42 - Tape, Packaging, Paper (Light Duty, Packaging and Bundling).
PPP-T-97 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101 - Preservation, Packaging and Packing Materials; Test Procedures.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are avialable without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets.
MIL-STD-1186 - Cushioning, Anchoring, Bracing, Blocking and Waterproofing, With Appropriate Test Methods.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials used in packaging and packing the desks shall be in accordance with the applicable specifications and as specified herein.

3.1.1 Lumber. All lumber used in the construction of the skid base shall conform to MIL-STD-731, class 2, using group I, II, or III woods. If hardwood (group IV of MIL-STD-731) is used in lieu of specified lumber, the thickness of the boards may be reduced provided the strength of the member so reduced is equal to or greater than that specified for the softwood.

3.1.2 Nails. All nails used in the construction of the skid base shall conform to FF-N-105 type II, style 7 (cement coated) or style 10 (helical design). The nails shall be of adequate length and diameter to prevent separation of components being joined by them and when possible, the nails shall be clinched a minimum of 1/4 inch. Alternatively, cement coated staples, 16 gauge, 7/16-inch crown, step point design of adequate length to permit clinching, shall be used.

3.1.3 Staples. The staples used for affixing the desk cover to the skid shall conform to FF-N-105 type III, style 3, crown width 1-inch, 16 gage, with a minimum leg length of 7/8 inch.

3.1.4 Polyethylene film. The polyethylene film used herein shall conform to L-P-378, type I, grade A, finish 1. The thickness shall be as specified herein.

3.1.5 Tape. The tape used for securing the pad to the desk top, securing the desk drawers, doors, and shelves and leg protectors and for securing the corners of the desk cover shall conform to PPP-T-97, type II, where 3/4-inch width is specified and type IV where 3-inch width is specified.

3.1.6 Cushioning material. The cushioning material specified herein shall conform to PPP-C-843, type I, class A and shall be a minimum of .120 thick, unless otherwise specified.

3.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1 Level A. The level A packaging shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1186.

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3.2.2 Level B. The various desks components shall be packaged as follows:

3.2.2.1 Sliding shelves, drawers, doors and legs. The exposed finished edge surfaces of sliding shelves and the top edges of doors and drawers shall be covered with strips of cushioning material (see 3.1.6). The strips shall be positioned so that they will remain in place when shelves, drawers, or doors are closed and secured. Drawers shall be closed and secured by either closing all pedestal drawers, then closing and locking the center drawer, or by closing all pedestal drawers, and inserting steel packing clips of the type normally used for the purpose. When closure is by locking the center drawer, the keys shall be placed in a kraft envelope or bag, a cloth bag or a polyethylene bag (the polyethylene bag, when used shall be not less than 1-1/2 mils thick). The key package shall then be secured to one of the drawer pulls with 3/4 inch tape or if the bag has a draw string that shall be utilized. When the steel clip method of securing the drawers is used, the keys shall be securely fastened within a top drawer. On desks furnished without a drawer locking device, each drawer shall be closed and secured prior to packing by the use of either the steel packing clips mentioned herein, or with strips of tape, 3/4-inch wide to hold the drawers closed under normal shipping impact (see 3.1.5). In all cases the sliding shelves shall be secured with tape or clips as described herein. The exposed portion of each leg shall be wrapped with a tube fabricated from fiberboard, conforming to PPP-F-320, type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275. The inner surface of the tubes shall be provided with a non-marring material. These tubes shall be secured in place with 3/4 inch tape.

3.2.2.2 Typewriter beds. When the desks are so equipped, the typewriter beds within the compartment shall be securely held in position by locking the elevator mechanism or by blocking and bracing with fiberboard, lumber, metal or a combination of these materials. Where such forms contact finished surfaces shall be protected against marring with cellulosic cushioning material (see 3.1.6).

3.2.2.3 Desk top surfaces and edges. The desk top surface and edges shall be protected with a full length cover or shroud fabricated form polyethylene film not less than 1 mil thick (see 3.1.4). In addition, the top and edges shall be completely covered with a desk top pad of cushioning material 1/4-inch thick (see 3.1.6). The desk top pad shall fold down over the edge on all four sides a minimum distance of 3-inches. The four corners of the pad shall be secured with 3/4-inch tape (see 3.1.5) to prevent the pad from sliding out of place. See figure 1 or 4, as applicable.

3.2.2.4 Skid base. The desk shall be mounted on a wooden skid base constructed as shown in either Figure 3 or 6, as applicable. The length and width dimensions of the finished skid shall be the same as those for the desk top, after it is wrapped as described in paragraph 3.2.2.3, except that the bottom skid boards shall extend 1/2 inch beyond the length dimension of the top boards at each end. The desk shall be secured to the skid base with four flat head machine screws or self tapping screws inserted through the lower skid frame into the gauge holes in the bottom of the desk legs. Alternatively, the desk shall be secured to the skid base with four 1/4 - 20 x 2 inch flat head machine screws inserted through the upper skid frame into the base of the pedestals or end panels. The holes in the skid base shall be aligned with the existing weld nuts in the pedestals and end panels.

3.2.2.5 Drawer partitions. The drawer partitions shall be wrapped to protect the finished surfaces and secured to the bottom of any drawer utilizing 3-inch wide tape conforming to PPP-T-42. The length of the tape shall be the length of the wrapped partitions, plus a minimum of 3-inches at each end for securing.

3.2.2.6 Desk cover. The desks, prepared for shipment as described above, shall be fitted with a close-fitting cover. The cover shall be fabricated from a single sheet of fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 and the construction shall be as shown in figure 7. See figure 1 and 2 or 4 and 5, as applicable for assembly.

3.2.3 Level C. Unless otherwise specified, desks and accessories shall be packed in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice providing it insures protection for the desk during shipment and safe delivery to its destination.

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3.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

3.3.1 Level A. The level A packing shall be in accordance with 3.3.2 except that the covers specified in 3.2.2.6, shall be constructed from material conforming to PPP-F-320, type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V11c. The closed packs shall be strapped as shown in either figure 2 or 5, as applicable using either 3/4 x .020-inch steel strapping conforming to QQ-S-781, type I, class B, or nonmetallic strapping conforming to PPP-S-760 type II or III, size 1/2 x .030 or 5/8 x .025.

3.3.2 Level B. The packaged desk shall be secured for shipment as follows: The desk cover shall be secured to the skid base with staples placed along every 6- + 1-inch of surface where the cover comes in contact with the skid base. The strips of tape 3-inches wide and 8- + 1/2-inch long shall be utilized to secure each corner of the container, as shown in either figure 2 or 5, as applicable (see 3.1.5).

3.3.3 Level C. Desks packaged as specified in 3.2.3 shall be packed in containers that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification rules or the National Motor Freight Classification rules.

3.4 Marking. In addition to the special marking required by 3.4.3 and any additional marking required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 3.4.1 or 3.4.2 as specified (see 6.2).

3.4.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

3.4.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

3.4.3 Special marking. In addition to the markings required by 3.4.1 or 3.4.2, the front, back and end panels of each shipping container shall be marked in each upper corner with the word "UP" and an arrow pointing to the top of the container (see figur 2 and 5). The end panels of the shipping container shall also be marked with the word "FRONT" and an arrow pointing to the front of the container, as shown in figures 2 and 5. "FRONT" and "UP" shall be printed in letters not less than 2-inches high. In addition, the top panel of the container shall be marked in letters not less than 2-inches high with the following:

TOP
THIS SIDE UP
FRAGILE - HANDLE WITH CARE

Additionaly, at least one side and one end shall be marked as follows, in characters not less than 2-inches high:

FURNITURE
FRAGILE - HANDLE WITH CARE

and the following in characters a minimum of 1-inch high, on containers complying with level A or B:

CAUTION
REMOVE SHIPPING SCREWS FROM
UNDERSIDE OF SKID BEFORE UNPACKING

The fork truck entry areas shall be printed on each container end and side, as shown in figures 2 or 5, as applicable. The end panels of the shipping container shall be marked to indicate the front of the desk and guidelines shall be marked on the ends to assist in alignment of units in warehouse stacking. These guidelines shall be shown in figures 2 and 5 and shall consist of a solid line on one end, on center and either two solid lines or a single dashed line on the opposite end, on center. The single pedestal desk containers shall be clearly marked on the front and applicable end "PEDESTAL END" in 1-inch minimum characters as shown in Figure 7.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

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4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsibile for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that packaging and packing materials were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein, or, if none, in accordance with the specification.

4.2 Testing of end item.

4.2.1 Test report. The tests specified herein are intended to determine compliance with the requirement for level A, B or C packing and shall be required on one model identical to the item being packed for each level of packing specified in the contract or order. A test reported, indicating no damage to the test item and no functional damage to the container and packing, will be accepted as proof of compliance for the level of packing specified in the contract or order when made available to the inspection service. The test results shall be obtained from tests conducted on an item of the identical model specified in the contract or order. Test reports, obtained as a result of tests conducted within 12 months prior to date of contract or order, shall contain a complete description of the packaging, packing, materials, and items packed, including drawings and pictures as needed. A packed item, tested after date of contract or order, shall be made available for identification by the Government representative and remain at the contractors plant until the last shipment on the contract is made. This unit shall be used as a guide in determining that packed items furnished on the contract conform to the sample unit tested and accepted. At the option of the Government the tests shall be witnessed by, or conducted under the supervision of a Government inspector.

4.2.2 Testing costs. All products, or containers damaged in making these tests shall be at the expense of the contractor or manufacturer.

4.3 Examination after testing. After the specified tests, for levels A, B or C in 4.4 have been accomplished, a visual examination shall be made of the shipping container and its contents. Any damage to the contents or functional damage to the container or packing shall be cause for rejection. Structural damage to the container, which would result in either loss of the contents or failure of the container in subsequent handling, is cause for rejection. Substantial shifting of contents within the container, that would create conditions likely to cause damage during shipment, storage, and reshipment, will also be cause for rejection. Minor container damage, such as chipping, abrasion, and superficial splitting of wood members and puncture of container panels, will not be cause for rejection.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Weight. The following tests cover procedures for preshipment testing of packed desks weighing 100- to 500-pounds. A test cycle in the order herein specified shall consist of all the tests required for a specific shipment.

4.4.1.1 Vibration test. A packed desk shall be tested in accordance with Method 5019 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101. The duration of the test shall be as follows for the level of pack specified:

Level A Pack - 2 hours.
Level B Pack - 1 hour.
Level C Pack - Not required.

4.4.1.2 Incline-Impact Test. A packed desk shall be tested in accordance with method 5023 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101. The optional timber shown in figure 1 of the test method shall not be used. An impact test cycle shall consist of one impact on each of the six faces of the pack and the number of cycles that constitute a complete test shall be as follows for the level of pack specified:

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Level A Pack - 2 cycles.
Level B Pack - 1 cycle.
Level C Pack - Not required.

4.4.1.3 Compression tests. This test shall be used to determine the ability of the shipping container and inside packing material to provide sufficient protection to its contents when subjected to loads simulating those imposed by stacking.

4.4.1.3.1 Test equipment. The test may be performed on a standard compression machine; or by applying a superimposed load to the top of the specimen container.

4.4.1.3.2 Test procedures. The specimen packed desk shall be placed on its base in an upright position, on a flat, level, rigid floor; and the prescribed load applied, or on the center of the bottom platen of the testing machine and the prescribed load applied. The test shall last for one (1) hour and the desk shall be capable of withstanding the prescribed load without damage as determined by paragraph 4.3. The compression load is determined by the following formula:

$$\text{Compression Load (Pounds)} = A \times \frac{(B-C)}{C} \times D$$

A - Weight of loaded container (Pounds).
B - Allowed stacking height - 15 foot minimum (Feet).
C - Height of container (Feet).
D - Safety factor.
For level A pack, D = 3.50
For level B pack, D = 2.00
For level C pack, - Not required.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Not applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. This specification covers the packaging, packing and marking requirements for desks, general office steel. It is intended for application to assembly line mass-produced products.

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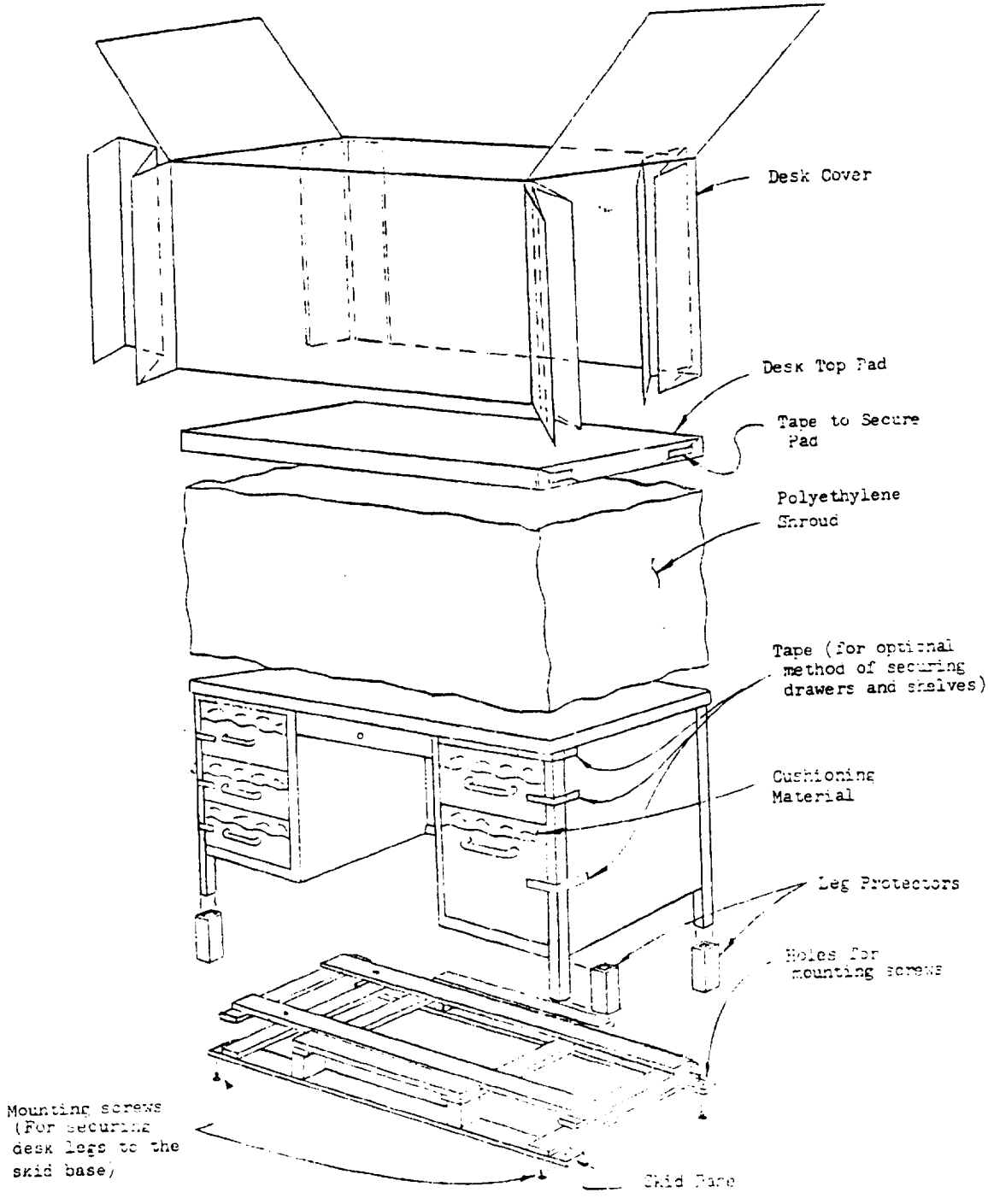


Fig. 1

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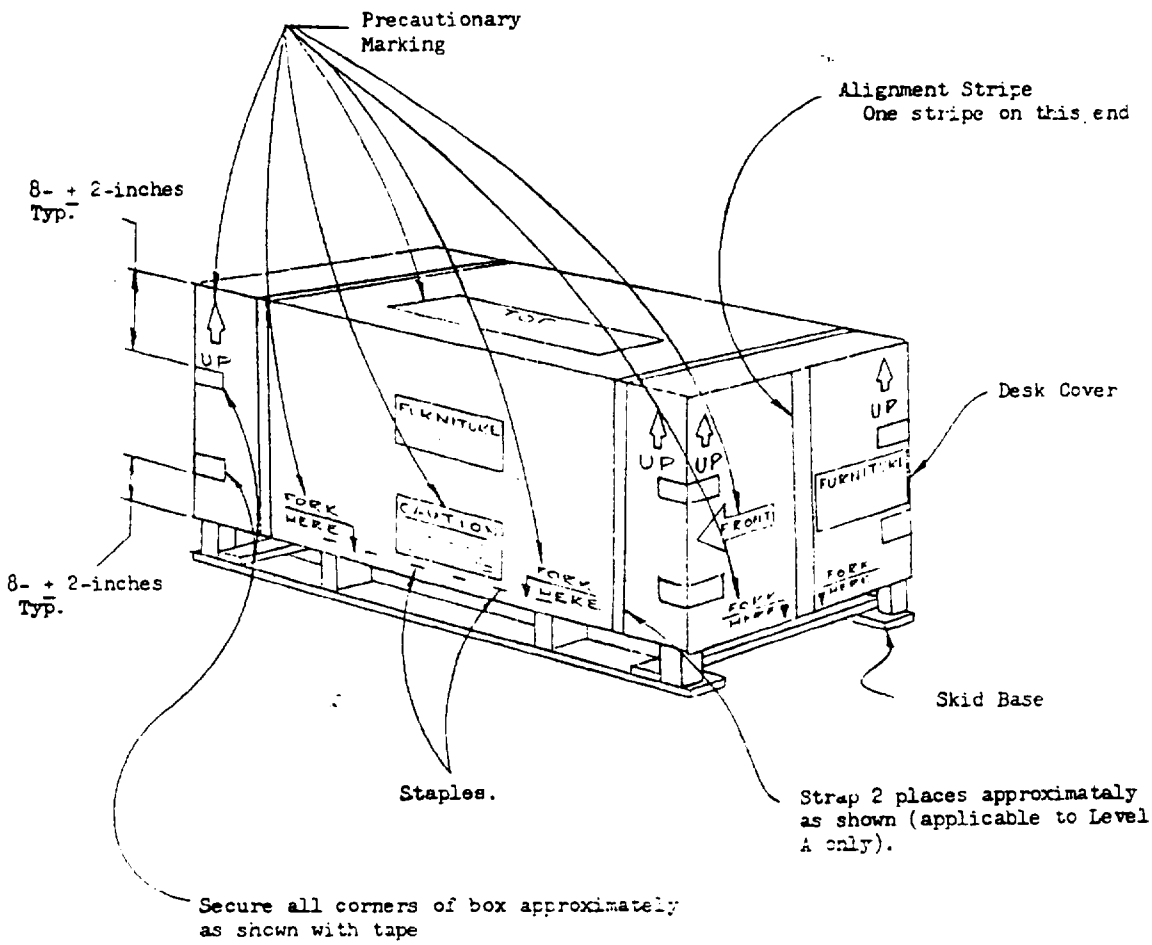
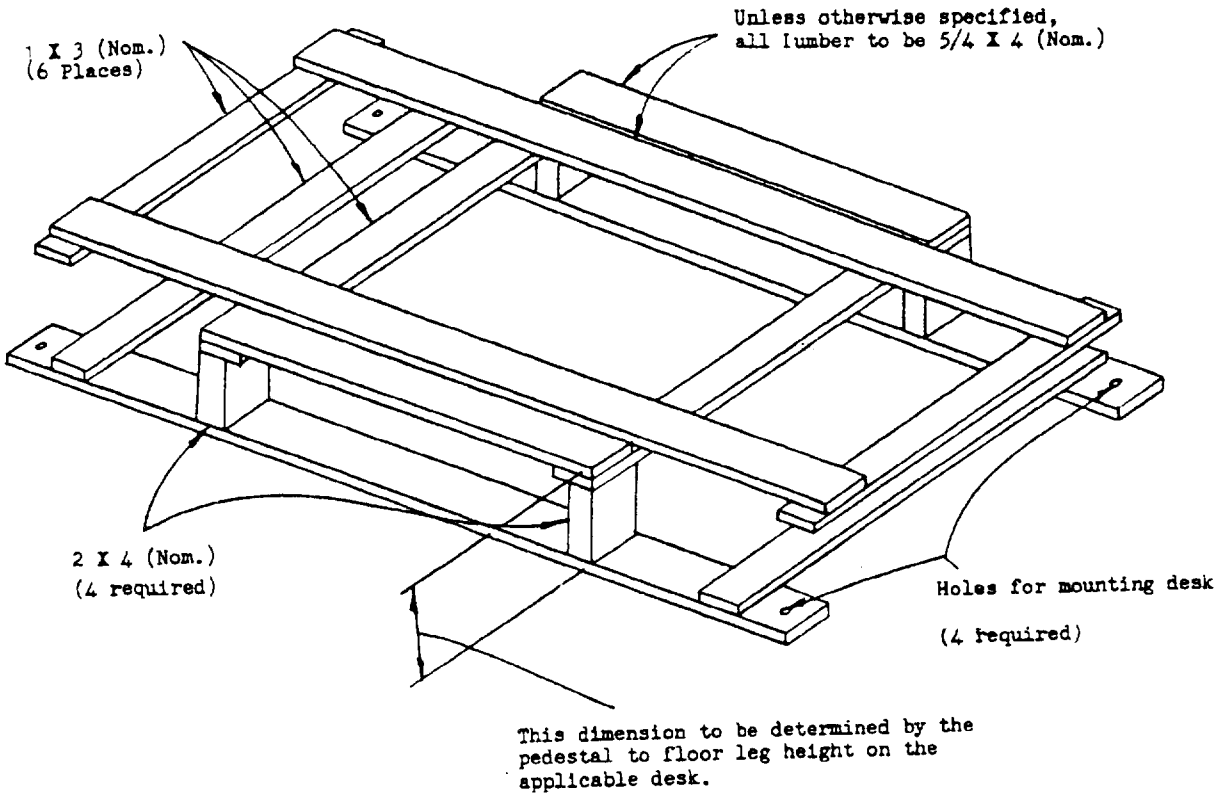
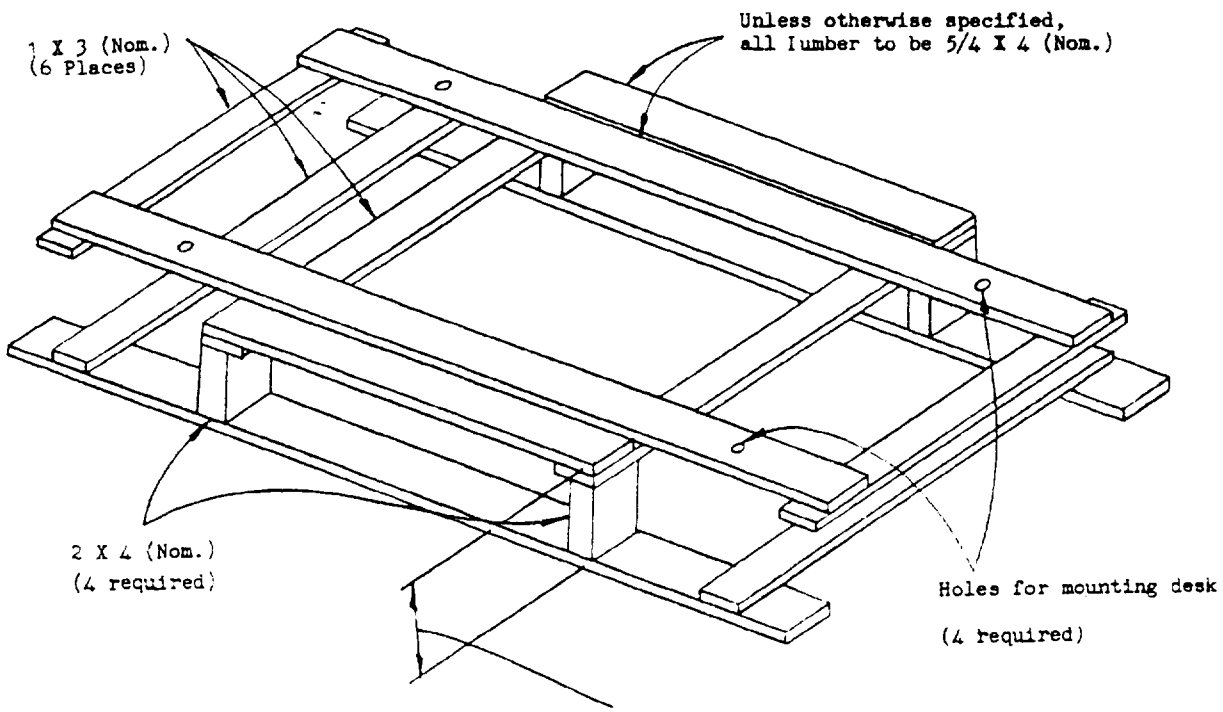


Fig. 2

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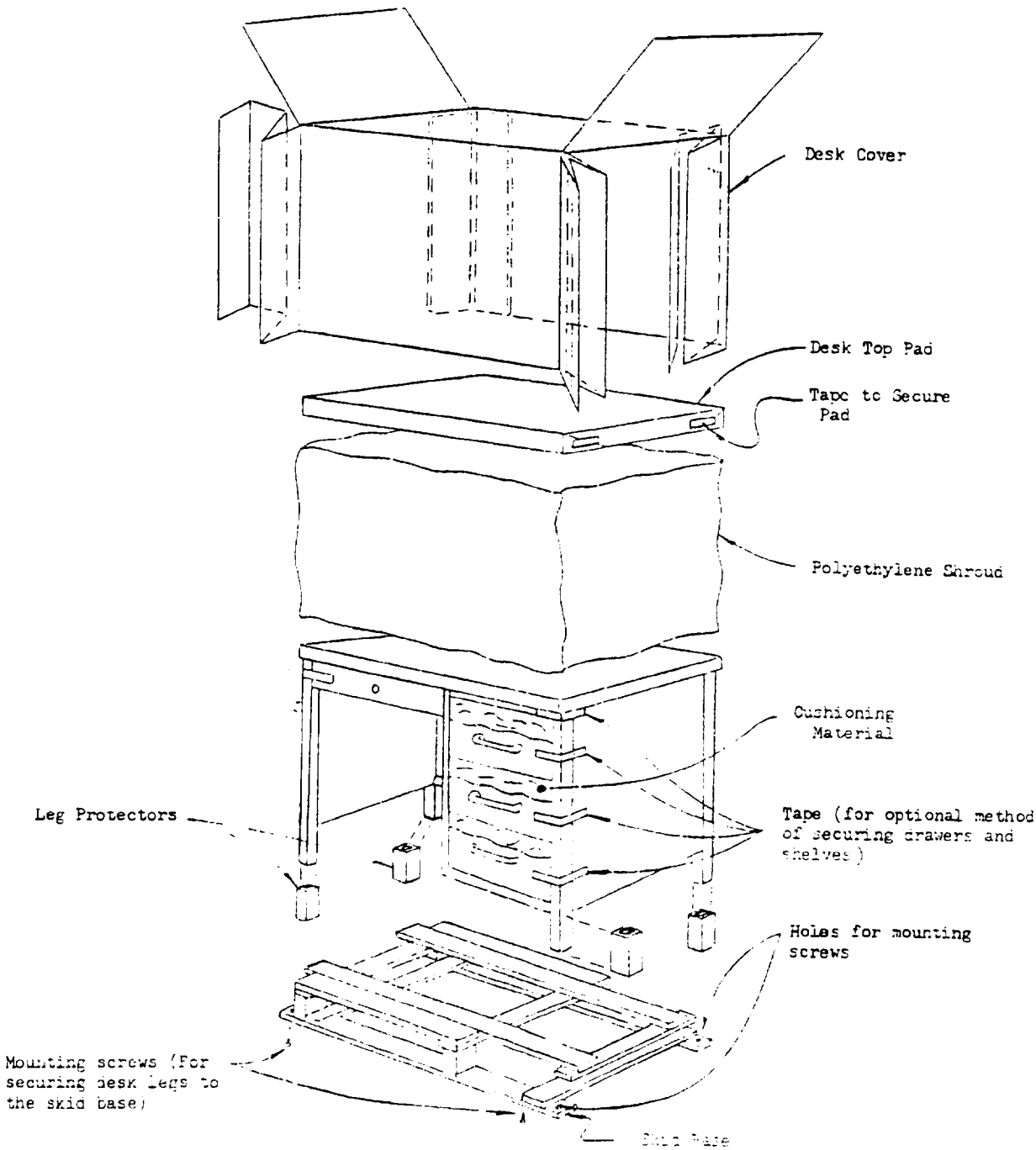


Fig. 4

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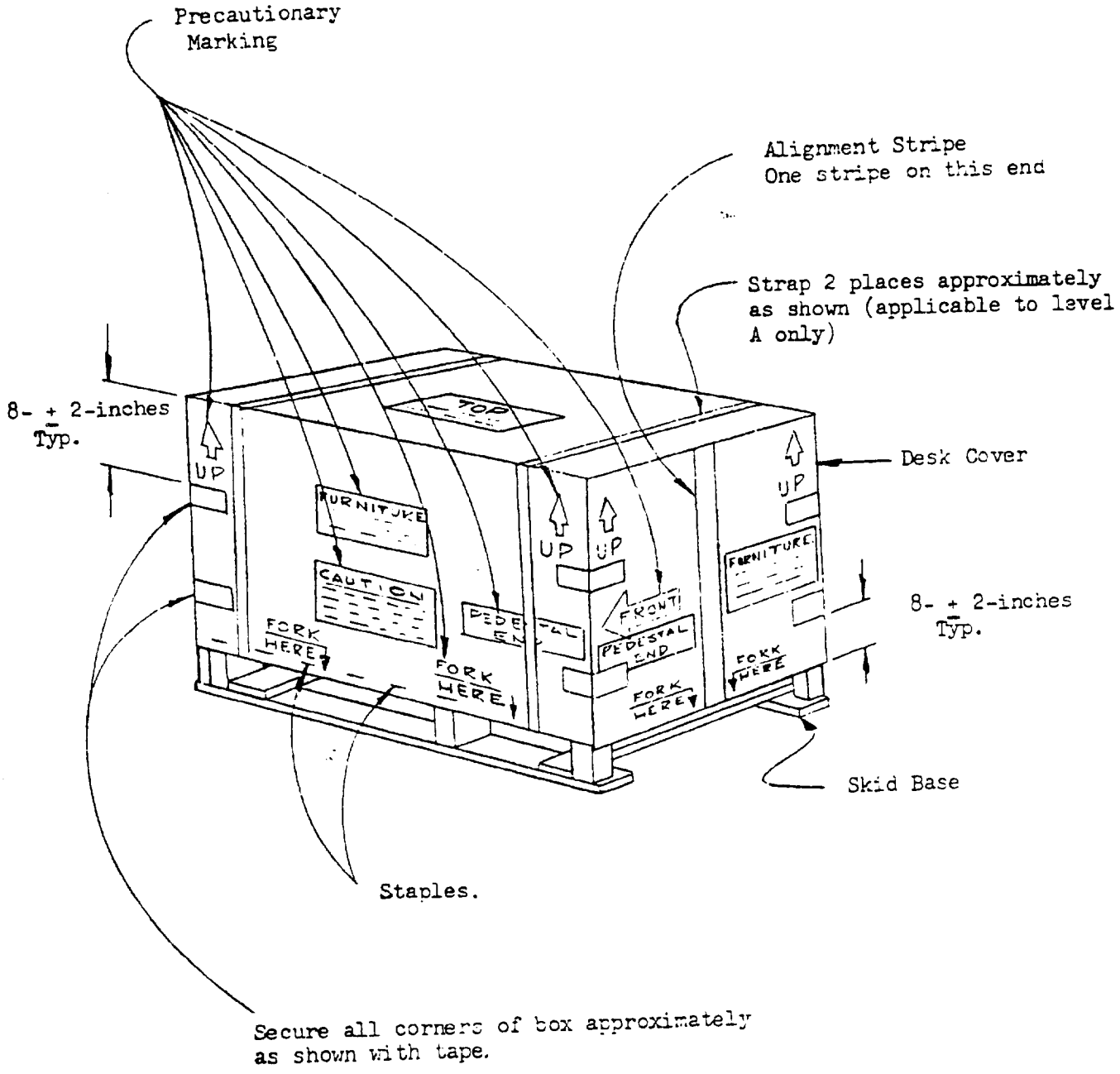
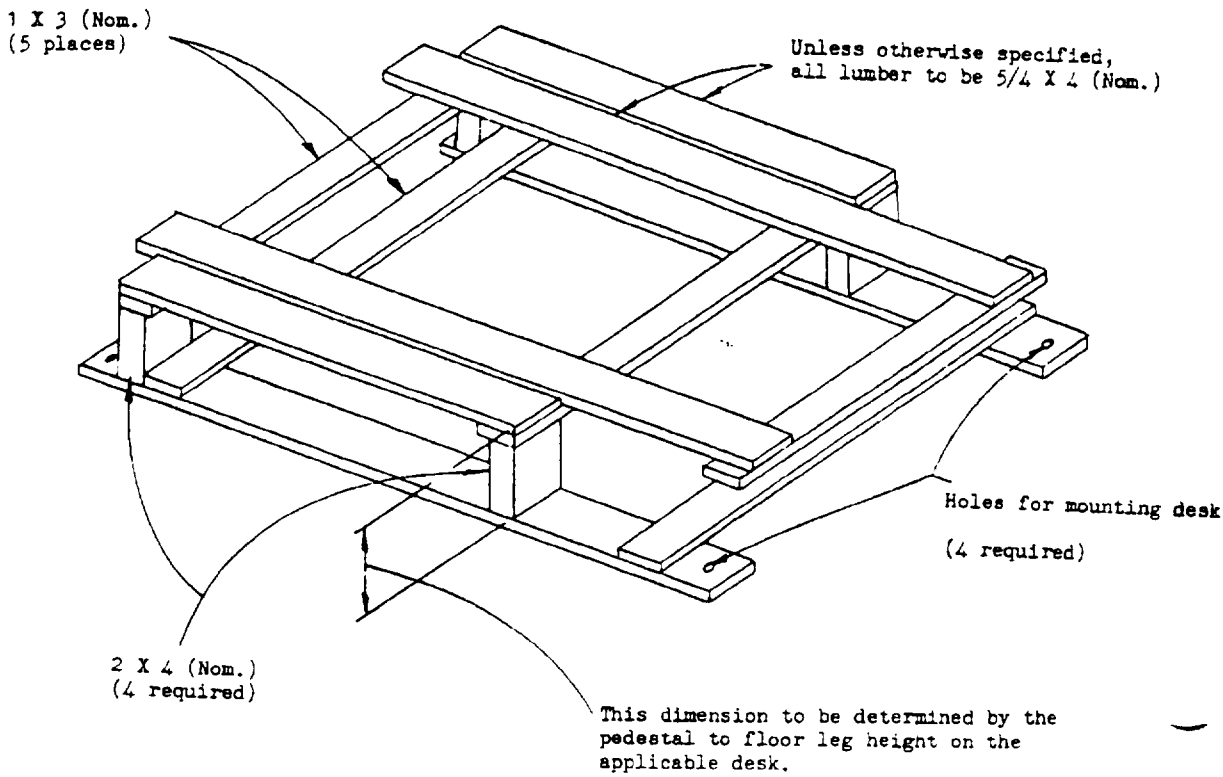
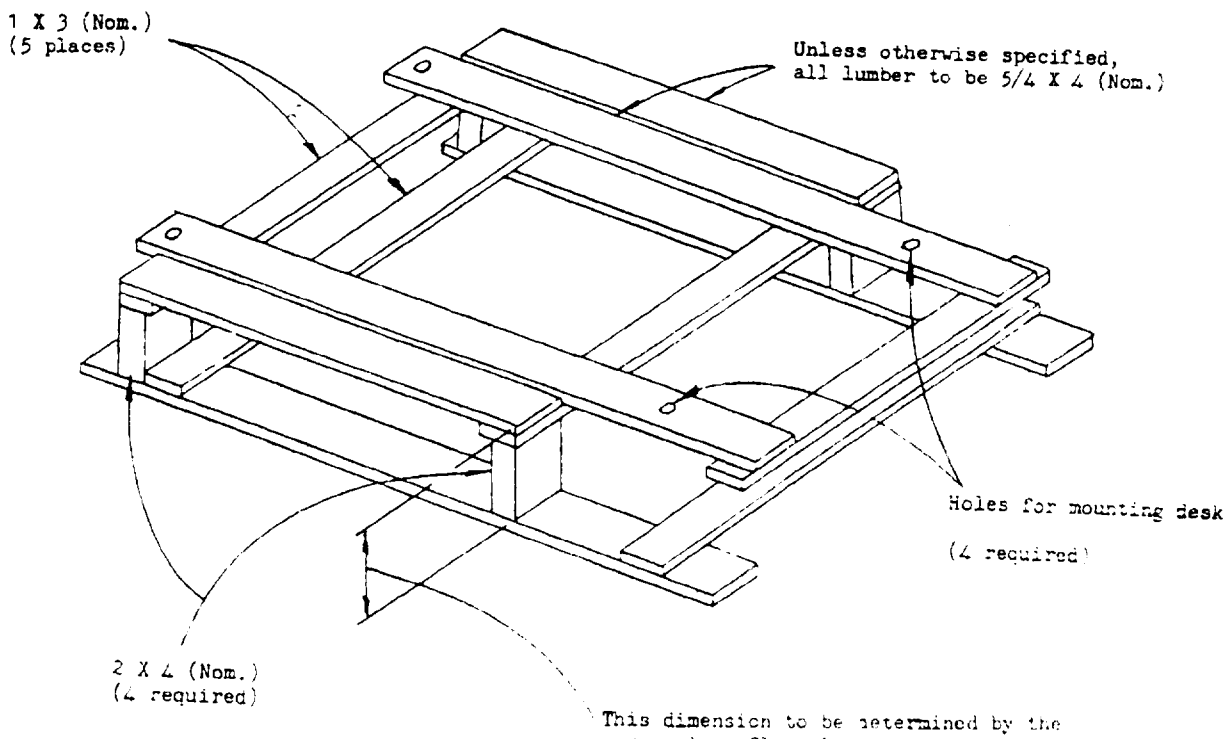


Fig. 3

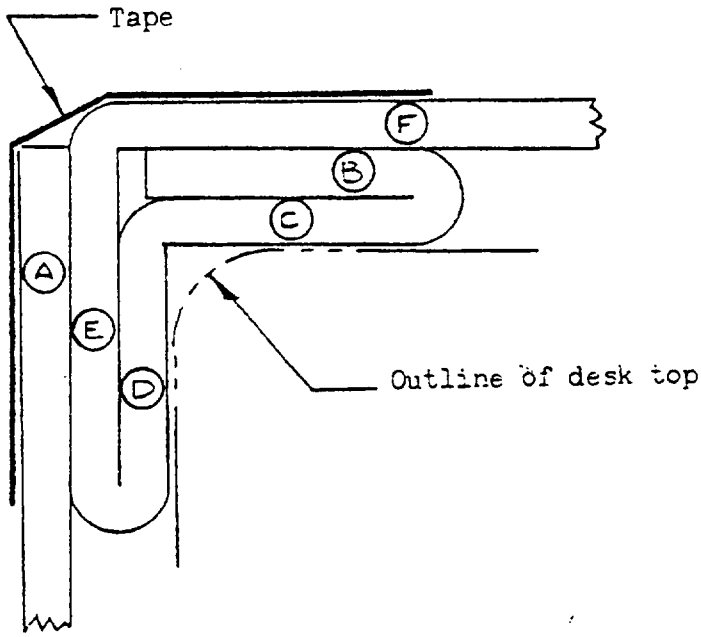
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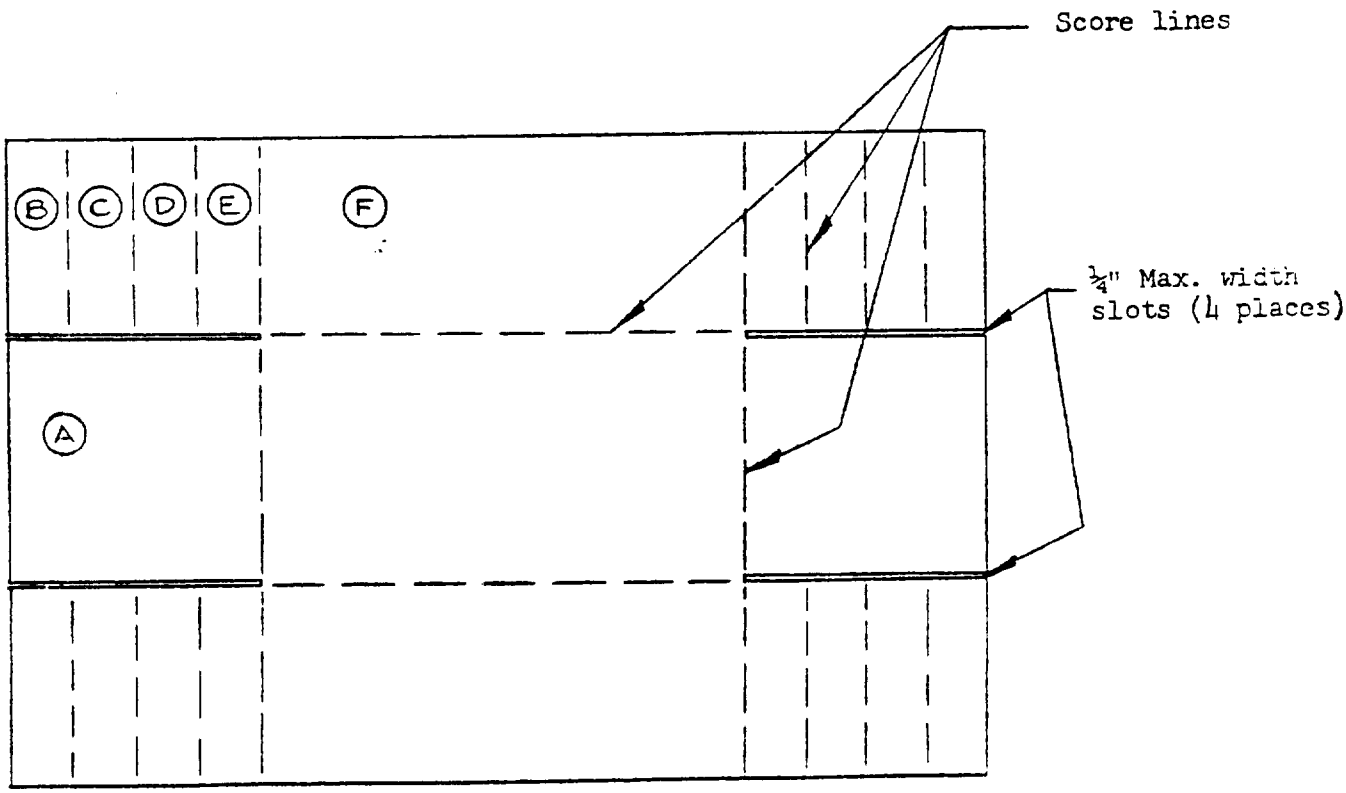


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Fig. 6



Typical Assembled Corner



Typical desk
cover pattern

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Level of packaging (see 3.2).
(c) Level of packing (see 3.3).
(d) Marking requirements (see 3.4).

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, which is an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies the other documents referenced herein.

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